

MODEL AVIATION

AUTHOR GUIDELINES AND SUBMISSION INFORMATION



FEATURE ARTICLES

Submission of Articles and Proposals

1. Proposals and ideas for future articles are submitted to Communications Director Rob Kurek at rkurek@modelaircraft.org. They do not necessarily contain all text and photos--just an excerpt of the article, description of the idea and content, and a few photos for review.

2. When we receive a proposal and review it, the author will be notified whether to submit more information (full content of text, photos, plans, etc.) or whether the proposal has been declined for acceptance at this time. Final acceptance or rejection is based on a review of all completed material. If the proposal is declined and sent by postal mail, all materials will be returned promptly.

3. Complete article submissions that include all content take time for necessary review, which is based on a number of factors, including length, complexity, and subject matter. Please take into consideration that the review of material might require several weeks.

4. Articles that are accepted for publication cannot be guaranteed a publication date. Editorial calendars are set months in advance of a published issue, of which production begins three months ahead of the publication date.

5. If at any time you wish to check the status of your proposal, article submission, or have questions, please contact Communications Director Rob Kurek at rkurek@modelaircraft.org or (765) 287-1256, ext. 220.

Construction articles and plans

1. Construction articles require full-size plans drawings in pencil, ink, or CAD. These can be submitted to us as nicely arranged and lettered pencil drawings on vellum, traced in ink by a draftsman, as finished ink drawings with mechanical lettering on drafting Mylar film (or equal), or in digital form as a full-size PDF or TIFF file. Professional-quality work is required in all instances.

2. Plans can be any length, with a maximum 36-inch width. A good rule of thumb for width is either 24 inches or 36 inches.

3. Plans are either sold online in the AMA Plans Service web store, are free PDF tiled or whole downloads on www.modelaviation.com, or a combination of both.

4. All plans should have a 1/2-inch line border around the edges.

5. Provide a specifications box in the lower right corner of the plans sheet(s) for information about the plans (name of aircraft, designer/drawn by, type of aircraft, size, power, weight, etc.) as well as room for the plans number. If more than one sheet, provide this information (Sheet 1 of 2, Sheet 2 of 2, etc.)

6. Plans should include a callout for the center of gravity, as well as a measurement line indicator or inch box.

7. Pencil drawings can be reproduced to have the same quality as ink if carefully and neatly done.

8. Callouts must be neat and uniform in size. They may be produced on a computer and pasted onto the sheet.

9. Pen weight should be no smaller than .35mm for inked and plotted drawings.

10. Suggested weight for the border is .60.

11. Line weight for digital files in PDF or TIFF format should be no less than 5 points for borders and no less than 2 to 3 points for actual plans lines.

12. Digital files may be PDF or TIFF at the highest possible resolution (300 to 600 dpi is recommended) and at the full plans size.

13. The Plans Service printers do not accept CAD files; however, *Model Aviation* can accept CAD files as long as they are .DWG extensions that can be converted using other programs. We would prefer they be sent as PDF or TIFF.

14. Hard copies of plans designed in CAD are required as back up.

15. Do not fold hard copies of plans. Instead, roll them up and send to us in a tube.

16. All plans used in construction articles for *Model Aviation*, and sold by the AMA Plans Service, become property of AMA; AMA owns the rights to both the plans and designs.

17. In a circumstance where permission is needed to kit, AMA will in each case re-release the rights for kitting only to the original designer six months after the design is printed in *Model Aviation*; if he or she wishes, a deal can then be made with a kit manufacturer. The Plans Service, however, will still be the only place to purchase the actual plan.

18. In all other instances, new plans must be drawn up to be sold outside of AMA; the plans AMA bought with the article and the design are proprietary unless previously authorized for re-sale as a short kit to a manufacturer. If plans are modified and/or the model is renamed, AMA owns no rights to the design. Even small changes (to airfoils, shapes, etc.) would render the resulting model as a new design.

19. For more information about the AMA Plans Service, visit <https://plans.modelaircraft.org> or call (765) 287-1256, ext. 507.

Payment for Feature Articles in *Model Aviation*

1. Submissions to sections of *Model Aviation* and on modelaviation.com, such as "In the Air," "Focal Point," and "Viewfinder" are unpaid.

2. *Model Aviation* has a payment-upon-acceptance policy; we do not buy all submissions.

3. Once the author is paid, *Model Aviation* owns the rights to the article, photos, and/or model design and plans, and reserves the authority to edit and change the text or photos as necessary.

4. Once owned by *Model Aviation*, the use of content in blogs, newsletters, online at modelaircraft.org or modelaviation.com, in *Model Aviation* Digital, or in displays or social media, is at the discretion of AMA and the Communications and Publications departments.

5. Before payment, all authors are required to sign the Author Agreement and Assignment (located on page 16) and provide a W-9 with social security number information for tax purposes (located on page 17). These can be submitted to Communications Director Rob Kurek at rkurek@modelaircraft.org or Managing Editor Jenni Alderman at jennifer@modelaircraft.org, or by postal mail at Attn: *Model Aviation*, 5161 E. Memorial Dr., Muncie IN 47302.

6. All feature article, product review, and construction plans payments are evaluated by the communications director and managing editor on an individual basis.

7. Payment is based on the number of magazine pages expected to be reserved for the article, whether the author has previously written for *Model Aviation*, his or her experience and knowledge, and the amount of additional work and expense required for the article to be publishable.

8. For product reviews, it is agreed by both the author/reviewer and *Model Aviation* that products are the property of the reviewer once the review has been accepted by *Model Aviation*. The product must stay in the reviewer's possession for six months after the review publication date. After six months, the reviewer may do what they wish with the product (i.e., sell, trade, etc.).

9. Upon acceptance of review products, the reviewer acknowledges and agrees that the review text, photos, and any videos become exclusive property of *Model Aviation*. No part of the review photos, videos, and/or text may be reproduced in whole or in part, or otherwise, without the permission of *Model Aviation*.

10. Accepted reviews are scheduled as needed by the editorial team. We cannot guarantee publication dates, but do our best to publish them as quickly as time and space permit.

TEXT AND CAPTION STYLE INFORMATION

Text

Feature articles should consist of approximately 1,400 to 2,000 words (to include sidebars, specifications, and any sources for contact information) and 10 to 15 photos with captions, dependent upon the subject matter. This would equal a maximum of between four and six pages for the graphic design layout.

1. Text font should be Times New Roman at 12 points, single-spaced, and formatted with 1-inch margins and .25-inch tab stops.
2. Please do not add page or section breaks. If section breaks are needed, use double spacing between sections, with a bold subhead title to emphasize the start of the next section.
3. Italics should be used for emphasis instead of uppercase letters, underlines, quotes, or bold.
4. The preferred word document program is Microsoft Word with the file extension of .doc.
5. Documents may be sent by postal mail to the attention of the Publications department on a flash drive, emailed as a file attachment, or sent via a file-sharing service such as DropBox, WeTransfer, or HighTail (preferred for large files), individually or as a zipped folder. If sending by email, please do not embed documents or text directly into the body of the message, which sometimes compresses them to a smaller size.
6. How-to information should be presented in a direct and orderly manner, but realize that a large part of the reading audience is not at an advanced level of modeling. Basic information should be included.
7. Avoid using slang terms. Abbreviations and acronyms should be spelled out in the first usage, with the abbreviation/ acronym in parentheses after it. Include an explanation of abbreviations and acronyms for the benefit of less-experienced or beginning modelers, if possible.
8. Give brand names of commercial products rather than (or in addition to) a generic description.
9. Include all sources of information and/or manufacturers and distributors, including telephone numbers and/or contact emails and website links at the end of your text.
10. *Model Aviation* editors use a mix of AP Style and an AMA style guide for aeromodeling terms, spelling, and definitions. We reserve the right to edit for grammar and style.

Captions

1. Caption information for photos should include the file name of each photo and numbered in order of preference.
2. Captions should be typed, nonrepetitive, descriptive, and kept to a maximum of 30 words or less.
3. Ordinarily, captions explain something that is visible in the photo, although some might be more general and refer to the text.
4. The preferred word document program is Microsoft Word with the file extension of .doc.

Product Review “At a Glance” Specification Boxes

Product reviews include a sidebar of specifications about the aircraft, whether an ARF, RTF, kit-built, electronics, etc., to include (but not limited to) main information such as the wingspan, weight, electronics used, pricing, flight duration, etc. Test-model details (if some of the components are different from what is included with the review model) can also be included. “Pluses” and “Minuses” with pros and cons about the aircraft are also included, as well as the Manufacturer/Distributor information. We encourage you to contact the manufacturer/distributor if there are any significant “minuses” that affect the quality or flying characteristics so that you can work with the company to find a possible solution/remedy before the review is published and include this information in the review. However, small minuses that can be worked through should be included. Model Aviation prides itself on publishing fair, nonbiased, and honest product reviews.

Below are some examples of specifications to include, dependent upon the type of aircraft and/or if applicable. Please see examples of product reviews in current issues of the magazine or the attached image on the next page.

***Model type:** (Scale, sport, Pattern, racer, electric, ARF, RTF, BNF, park flyer, etc.)

***Skill level:** (Beginner, Intermediate to Expert, Advanced, etc.)

***Construction type:** (balsa, composite, foam, etc.)

***Wingspan:**

Wing area:

Wing loading:

Length:

***Weight:** (with or without fuel, battery)

***Recommended power system:** (engine/motor size and/or type)

***Recommended power/control system:** (ESC, servos, receiver, etc.)

Recommended propeller size

***Radio system:** (channels, brand, etc.)

Needed to complete (any additional components such as

***Flight time:**

***Price:**

***Required**

Test-Model Details

If applicable, you may also include a “Test-Model Details” section, if components were added or different from what the manufacturer recommended or what came with the model. This can also be more specific about what was included with the model kit, such as the receiver, propeller and size, etc.

Pluses/Minuses

Short bullet points of the pros and cons found about the model aircraft. There might not be any minuses, but make sure to highlight what was found great about the model.

Manufacturer/Distributor

List the name of the manufacturer, as well as contact information (phone number or email and website). If it was obtained by a US distributor, list that as well. All other sources for products used in the product review will be listed at the end of the text in the “Sources” section.



At A Glance



Specifications

Model type: EPS foam microscale

Skill level: Intermediate to expert

Wingspan: 32.3 inches

Wing Area: 170 sq. in.

Airfoil: Patey "transforming airfoil"

Length: 20.2 inches

Weight: 10.4 ounces (295 grams) with a 4S 300 mAh LiPo

Motor: 1412-1500 Kv brushless 12-pole

Radio: Six-channel

Construction: EPS foam

Price: \$219.99

Requires: DSMX-compatible six-channel transmitter and receiver; 3S or 4S LiPo battery



Test Model Details

Motor Used: 1412-1500 Kv brushless 12-pole (included)

ESC: Receiver-integrated (included)

Battery: 3S 300 or 4S 300 mAh LiPo (required)

Propeller: Four-blade 128mm x 85.4mm (included)

Radio System: Spektrum iX14 transmitter

Ready-to-fly weight: 10.4 ounces (295 grams) with a 4S 300 mAh Spektrum battery

Wing Loading: 8.8 ounce per sq. ft.

Flight Duration: 5 to 7 minutes



Pluses

- Functional scale features, including flaps and LED navigation, landing, and other lights.
- Officially licensed replica of Mike Patey's full-scale airplane.
- One-piece wing with flaps and easy-on struts.
- Tundra-style tires, active suspension, and steerable tailwheel.
- Compatible with 3S and 4S 300 mAh batteries.
- Ready to fly in minutes.



At a Glance



Specifications

Model type: Sport scale Reno Racer

Skill level: Intermediate to advanced

Wingspan: 42.1 inches

Wing area: 321 sq. in.

Length: 38.2 inches

Weight: 39.5 ounces

Power system: Brushless electric

Radio: Minimum six channels required

Construction: EPO foam

Price: \$259.99

Test-Model Details

Motor: Predator 3948-900Kv brushless outrunner (included)

ESC: Predator 80-amp with 5-amp BEC; EC5 connector (included)

Battery: 14.8-volt 4S 2,600 to 4,000 mAh recommended

Propeller: 10.5 x 8 four-blade (included)

Radio system: RadioMaster TX16S transmitter; LemonRX six-channel DSMR receiver

Ready-to-fly weight: 50 ounces with a Zippy 60C 4S 2,700 mAh battery

Flight duration: Five to six minutes



Pluses

- Pilots can use batteries as large as a 4S 4,000 mAh LiPo pack.
- All control horns and ball-link-equipped pushrods are preinstalled.
- Chrome spinner and four-blade propeller.
- Top speed of 85 to 90 mph out of the box.



Minuses

- The forward location of a P-51's tail wheel can make tracking during the takeoff roll challenging.



Manufacturer/Distributor

FMS

(800) 338-4639

www.fmsmodel.com

Horizon Hobby

(800) 338-4639

www.horizonhobby.com

PHOTOGRAPHY GUIDELINES

Photos and Images

1. We will accept glossy (not matte) color prints from 35mm manual or digital cameras. Do not mark on the back of hard copy photos with felt-tip, permanent, or ball-point pens because the ink bleeds through and cannot be removed.
2. Please turn off date-stamp feature in your camera's settings.
3. Cellphone photography will be accepted as long as it is a newer smartphone with large photo sizes available.
4. Do not embed text through a photo processing program onto digital photos as "callouts."
5. The minimum size and resolution required by our printing press is 300 dpi at 5 x 3, the equivalent size of approximately 20 x 16 at 72 dpi, or at the highest JPG setting available in a digital camera.
6. Digital photos originating from hard copies should be scanned at the highest setting possible for resolution (600 dpi is preferred).
7. Photo file formats/extensions excepted are JPG/.jpg, TIFF/.tif, RAW, or HEIC. PNG/.png and PDFs are accepted for line art and graphs if they are a large, high-resolution size.
8. Please do not embed photos into Word documents, email, or PDFs. Instead, save them as attachments or separate photo files. This sometimes compresses the size and resolution.
9. Do not digitally enhance/fix/"Photoshop" photos. Our graphic designers are experienced in correcting photos and use several programs to make necessary adjustments so that they look as good as possible.
10. Do not embed or inset photos within photos. If you wish for photos to be placed together or inset with each other, please note this in the caption text information and our graphic designers will put them together in the best possible way.
11. Try to get a mix of vertical and horizontal photos.
12. Remember to consider your surroundings and elements when taking photos: removing hats eliminates facial shadows; busy and/or cluttered backgrounds take away the focus of the photo. Do not cut off photo subjects (hands, airplane wings, legs, etc.). Think about photo composition, considering secondary objects or colors that blend in or merge together with the subject(s).
13. When taking photos of model aircraft in flight, make sure that the camera's shutter speed is set so that the blades/propellers are not stopped mid-air and that it looks like it's suspended and/or nonmoving. A good rule of thumb is for a shutter speed between 1/160 and 1/320 of a second. It is a good idea *not* to use cellphone cameras for flying shots unless you have the option to change the shutter speed in the settings ("Pro"/manual settings).
14. For fast-moving/non-propeller aircraft such as jets and racers, use a high shutter speed so that motion is stopped. For crisp, detailed shots, the ideal shutter speed is between 1/1000 and 1/2000 of a second. If you want to create a sense of motion with a blurred background, use a slower speed of 1/125 to 1/250 of a second while smoothly panning your camera to keep the aircraft in focus.
15. Photos that are too small in size, low resolution, low-quality (fuzzy, jpg noise), out of focus, or are of too-far-away subjects that cannot be recognized will be rejected. *Model Aviation* reserves the right to not use any photo that does not meet resolution or size requirements, and, if needed, might ask for additional photos that fit the requirements.
16. We will not accept photocopies (color or black and white) on regular paper, or laser prints from home ink-jet printers (except as proof of the digital files furnished).
17. We will not accept "copied," "gleaned," or "screenshot" photos from the internet. Website photos are normally not large enough to use in print. If you need to use a photo you have viewed on a website or in an internet search, please contact the owner of the website/image for an original copy and permission to use, and cite this information/source in your provided text and caption information.
18. Just because it is on the internet does not mean it is free for use; copyright to an image belongs to its creator whether copyright has been registered or not. Always assume ownership: Unless a photo is explicitly labeled as public domain or features a specific Creative Commons license, it is protected. Presume permission is needed to use any images acquired from the internet.
19. Consent for photos acquired from other sources or AMA members and not taken by you as the author is required. Include within the caption information who took the photo (Photo by XXX) or by whom consent to publish was given if it is a company or other (Permission to publish given by XXX).
20. Consent is required from anyone featured in photographs to be published. Consent is required for youth under the age of 18 from a parent or guardian. Written consent is preferred (whether paper or email), but verbal will be accepted.

21. Grayscale (black and white) photos are accepted.

22. *Model Aviation* designers reserve the right to redraw line art or illustrations in order to fit our style and standards.

23. Selection and publication of all photo and line art/illustration submissions is subject to the approval of the magazine staff.

24. Digital images may be sent by postal mail to the attention of the Publications department on a flash drive/SC card, emailed as a file attachment, or sent via a file-sharing service such as DropBox, WeTransfer, or HighTail (preferred for large files), individually or as a zipped folder. If sending by email, please do not embed photos directly into the body of the message.

25. When in doubt about the size of an image, feel free to send it to us to check the dimensions.

Bonus Video Content

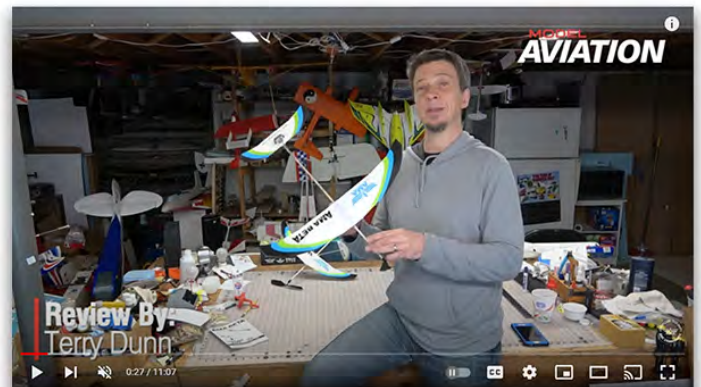
We welcome interaction from our members with videos they have taken of their aircraft flying, of step-by-step how-tos or tutorials, or even event coverage that can be used as supplements on ModelAviation.com or in *Model Aviation* Digital to material in *Model Aviation* print. In order for videos to be the best possible, here are some guidelines to follow.

This can be overwhelming, but most newer, mid-level consumer camcorders shoot at the quality noted below or higher. We don't want you to become distracted by these details. We prefer you focus on the content and telling a great story. Most importantly—have fun.

1. If you are editing video, please keep it short. Digital viewers have limited attention spans. Less than 4 minutes is best.
2. We can accept most formats (.mov, .avi, .flv, .mp4, .wmv); however, for optimal results, use .mp4/MPEG-4 (Divx, H.264, Xvid) format.
3. Although we prefer .mp4, do not convert your video if it is in a different format. Allow us to do the conversion in-house.
4. Frame rates should be at least 24p or higher.
5. Ideal resolution should be at least 1280 x 720 (720p).
6. We prefer a 16:9 aspect ratio (widescreen), but 4:3 is acceptable.
7. If you have the option, please do not let the bitrate drop below 1,000 kps.
8. Please respect copyrights. Submit videos that you have shot yourself or that you have consent and permission to use. Please include information about who the video is by (Video by XXX) or by whom consent to publish was given if it is someone else (Permission to publish given by XXX).
9. *Do not add* music to your video (unless it happens to be playing in the background). If you do add music or other video clips, please provide us with all documentation verifying that you are not violating copyright laws.
10. Files of videos may be submitted via email as an attachment, by DVD through postal mail, or through a file share service such as Dropbox, WeTransfer, or HighTail. If you would rather link to a video through a website such as YouTube or Vimeo, send us a direct web address link for viewing.

11. *Model Aviation* encourages members to keep copies of their videos because they become property of MA upon publication and will not be returned.

12. Selection and publication of all videos is subject to the approval of the magazine staff.



Product Spotlight: Worth a Closer Look

We have found some of these items on our own, but many have been brought to our attention by outside sources. If you have a product or service that you feel might be “worth a closer look,” contact Communications Director Rob Kurek by email at rkurek@modelaircraft.org or Managing Editor Jenni Alderman at jennifer@modelaircraft.org.

Product Spotlight: Modeler's Mall

1. Product releases may be sent via email within the body text or attached as a PDF or Word document, or by postal mail with text and photos on a disk or flash drive. See the “How to Submit” and “Photography Guidelines” sections for text and photo requirements.

2. We cannot reproduce low-quality or low-resolution photos taken directly from websites. Please provide photos of a minimum of 300 dpi/5 x 3, the equivalent of 72 dpi/20 x 16, or the highest available JPG setting in a camera.

3. Text information for "Modeler's Mall" will be taken directly from the release; however, if not enough information is included about the product, it will be taken from the manufacturer's website. A maximum of 200-250 words will be included.

4. Manufacturers and distributors should provide their telephone number and/or email, a website address, and the purchase/retail price of the product for the consumer.

5. *Model Aviation* and the "Product Spotlight" section do not imply any endorsements of products.

6. Information and photos should be sent to Managing Editor Jenni Alderman at jennifer@modelaircraft.org or by postal mail: Attn: Modeler's Mall, 5161 E. Memorial Dr., Muncie IN 47302. Inquiries can also be directed to Advertising and Partnership Director Erin Dobbs at erind@modelaircraft.org.



Focal Point

Are you proud of your latest building or flying effort? Send us a photo with detailed information about the model and its specifications and we will publish it!

Readers love to know all of the little details about what others are building and flying, such as the type of model, why it was chosen, what it was covered with or why a specific scheme was used, measurements, power and control components (motor/engine, electronics, servos, radio and receiver, propeller, etc.), any design or detail customizations, as well as how it flies and where you fly it. You can even include a little bit about yourself, such as how long you have been an AMA member or flying.

Please note that there is often a backlog of submissions because of the popularity of this section of the magazine, and it might be several months before it is published. Submissions are published in the order that they are received.

1. Text should be a maximum of 200-250 words in length. Photos should be high-quality at a minimum size of 5 x 3 at 300 dpi, the equivalent size of approximately 20 x 16 at 72 dpi, or the highest JPG setting available in a camera.

2. Photos should be restricted to the model with or without the owner/builder. Please refrain from photos that depict other members of your family or your friends unless they were involved with the building/flying.

3. Material of a questionable or inappropriate nature will not be considered for use in any "Focal Point" presentation.

4. Please supply your city/state and/or AMA number, as well as your email address (if available) so that interested parties may contact you directly.

5. Submissions can be made by email (with photo as an attachment, not embedded within the message body) or by postal mail on a disk/flash drive or as a hard copy (see Photography Guidelines). All submissions should be sent to Managing Editor Jenni Alderman, Attn. Focal Point, at 5161 E. Memorial Dr., Muncie IN 47302 or emailed to jennifer@modelaircraft.org.

6. Questions about the text submission or photo quality/size can be directed to Managing Editor Jenni Alderman at jennifer@modelaircraft.org or (765) 287-1256, ext. 223.

Viewfinder

Do you have a high-quality/high-resolution aircraft photo you are proud of, or a model aviation-related photo with a great story behind it? We're looking for submissions to publish on the "Viewfinder" page in *Model Aviation* magazine.

1. A high-resolution photo at the highest JPG setting in your camera of a minimum of 5 x 3 at 300 dpi or the equivalent size of approximately 20 x 16 at 72 dpi. If photos need to be scanned, it should be done at at least 600 dpi as a TIFF or JPG.

2. Information for this section should include three to four short paragraphs (400 words maximum) about the background of the photo, including where the photo was taken (event, club, backyard, city/state), historical significance (if applicable), the names of anyone in the photo, and any other interesting information you would like to provide.

3. Information about the type of camera used, as well as (if known) lens used, lens length, and settings (f-stop/ISO/mode settings such as Aperture or Shutter Priority), is not required, but can be included.

4. Submissions may be made by email (with the photo as an attachment, not embedded within the message body) or by postal mail on a disk/flash drive or as a hard copy (see Photography Guidelines). All submissions should be sent to Managing Editor Jenni Alderman, Attn. Viewfinder, at 5161 E. Memorial Dr., Muncie IN 47302 or emailed to jennifer@modelaircraft.org.

5. Questions about the text submission or photo quality/size can be directed to Managing Editor Jenni Alderman at jennifer@modelaircraft.org or (765) 287-1256, ext. 223.





Common Questions

AMA members can learn more about the aeromodeling legacy in occasional installments of "Common Questions," a series of questions and answers about companies, brands, or organizations within our hobby.

If you or your company/organization would like to be a part of "Common Questions," contact Communications Director Rob Kurek at rkurek@modelaircraft.org or (765) 287-1256, ext. 220.

About Us

AMA members can learn more about the aeromodeling legacy and are invited to respond to a question for a chance to win prizes! Occasional installments of "About Us" highlight a company, brand, or organization within our hobby, not only to provide members with good information, but also to give you the opportunity to interact and have more fun with the Academy's flagship publication.

If you or your organization would like to be a part of the "About Us" program, contact Communications Director Rob Kurek at rkurek@modelaircraft.org or (765) 287-1256, ext. 220.



MA Photography Guidebook

A handbook for submitting photos that meet *Model Aviation* photo standards

Desirable:

Mix of horizontal and vertical photos



When taking photos for your article and/or event coverage, try to get a mix of horizontal and vertical shots. Sending both a horizontal and vertical version of the same photo (if possible) is extremely helpful to the designer in selecting the best orientation to maximize visual impact in your article.

Undesirable:

Dark, shadowy faces



Fair: Hats put faces in shadows

Consider your lighting choices. Many aeromodeling events are held outside in the bright sunlight. For static photos, taking a picture with your subject's back to the sun (with you facing the sun) will most often result in darkened, barely recognizable faces. To combat dark faces, try using the flash on your camera to balance the light from behind with



Good: Removing hat eliminates shadow

light from the front. Along the same lines, try to avoid taking photos of people wearing sunglasses or hats--the bill of the hat casts a shadow across the face. Ask him or her to remove or turn the hat around, or try to snap the photo under a simple tent where eyes won't be squinting.

Terms used in this guidebook and their meaning:

Candid: Not posed or set up

Composition: The makeup of your photo

Depth of Field: The area or "zone" of a photograph, from front to back, that is in focus

Objects, Subject: The focus of your photo

Undesirable:
Busy and/or cluttered
backgrounds



Poor: The chair pattern is too busy and takes focus away from airplane



Poor: The desktop is too cluttered



Fair: Clearing the desk is better



Good: Eliminating all background clutter is best

When taking photos set up for illustrations or sequencing (for example: a sequence of construction photos), place the subject on a simple, solid-colored background. Do not use a building shop (with glue and other

items lying around), a couch, a kitchen table, or similar backdrops for photographing subjects. Try finding a solid background, such as a blank wall or posterboard in contrasting colors.

Undesirable:
Cutoff photo subjects



Cutoff people, airplanes, or other subjects will not be accepted.



Please do not take your images into Photoshop or other photo editing programs and embed a photo, words, cutouts, etc. into another. Allow our graphic designers do the work for you in an graphically pleasing manner by giving us instructions to do so.

Undesirable:
Words or other photos pasted onto photo



Make sure that your subject matter is in focus. A good picture uses focus to draw your eyes to the subject. Objects and people that are blurred in an image are weaker photos overall and less desirable than those in focus. Please note that blurry backgrounds and foregrounds caused by the depth of field are acceptable.

Undesirable:
Out-of-focus photos



Poor: The modeler on the left is growing a pole out of his head

Think about picture composition. Consider secondary objects when taking a photo. Make sure that people do not take on extra limbs in the form of trees or poles. Also, watch for blending. Sometimes two subjects or a subject and the background can



Poor: Note how the orange airplane blends into the red outfit

merge together. For example, a modeler with a bright red t-shirt holding a bright red airplane becomes one big bright red photo with an almost indistinguishable subject. In this case, try having the modeler put the airplane on the ground and kneel next to it.

Undesirable:
New limbs or subjects that blend together



Undesirable:
The “grip and grin”
photo

Fair: If the people in this photo had not been looking to the cameras and posing with the award, this would be a good photo.

Avoid “grip and grin” photos. Many award events yield photos of people standing with their award, smiling in a less-than-comfortable way. Aim to

find more candid, action shots if possible. For example, try to get a picture of that person in the process of receiving the award.

Other general guides:

Digital photos printed on laser or inkjet photo paper will not be accepted.

The more photos you can submit, the better. *Model Aviation* retains the right to select the best photos for the layout and information presentation. All of your photos may or may not be included. The best way to ensure that a photo is published is to create solid photo composition, not cut off people or airplanes, keep it in focus, and submit the photo in a format workable for us (an original hard copy print or high-resolution digital file). If you have doubts or have questions about any of this, contact Managing Editor Jenni Alderman at (765) 287-1256, ext. 223, or jennifer@modelaircraft.org.

Summary:

Photos with the following attributes will not be considered or accepted:

- Cutoff subjects
- Cluttered backgrounds (for non-event photos)
- Digital files at too low of a resolution
- Embedded together in Photoshop
- Printed on laser or inkjet photo paper
- Out of focus

Rules of thumb for digital photograph sizes

72 dpi: 1500 x 900 pixels = 20.8 x 12.5 inches

300 dpi: 1500 x 900 pixels = 5 x 3 inches

72 dpi: 1800 x 1200 pixels = 25 x 16.6 inches

300 dpi: 1800 x 1200 pixels = 6 x 4 inches

72 dpi: 3000 x 2250 pixels = 41.6 x 31.25 inches

300 dpi: 3000 x 2250 pixels = 10 x 7.5 inches

The size of a photo can be found by taking it into a photo editing program (such as Photoshop) and checking the image size, or by right-clicking on a photo and searching its properties (under the Properties "Details" tab).

****Note:** Images for *Model Aviation* (photos, graphs, plans, etc.) are required by the printing press to be 300 dpi at a minimum of 5 x 3 inches, as either a JPG or TIFF file. We can convert from 72 dpi; however, the sizes must be aligned to the chart above (there is no maximum image size; they can be provided at a larger size than 10 x 7.5 at 300 dpi). Image sizes that are smaller than those stated above might be returned and larger ones requested.

Make sure that your camera's photo settings are for the highest JPG or TIFF option that is available. Photos can be taken *down* in size, but not *up* in size without the quality degrading. When in doubt, send a photo to us and we can check the sizing for you!

***Model Aviation* is ...**

- The flagship publication of the Academy of Model Aeronautics (AMA).
- The official voice of the AMA, supporting the Academy's Mission and Vision.
- A monthly publication covering all aspects of the hobby and sport.
- Provided as a membership benefit at no extra charge.
- Available by subscription and found in select hobby shops in the U.S. and Canada.
- The best source for news about the Academy and its programs.
- The place to find information concerning new products, aeromodeling events, and helpful how-to articles.

***Model Aviation* Mission Statement**

Model Aviation is the flagship publication of the Academy of Model Aeronautics. *Model Aviation* serves as a vehicle to accomplish the purposes of the organization and a means by which official information is distributed to the membership. *Model Aviation* supports the mission of the Academy of Model Aeronautics. *Model Aviation* strives to inspire, inform, and instruct enthusiasts who share a passion for aeromodeling. *Model Aviation* covers the full spectrum of aeromodeling activities, and serves as an important historical resource. *Model Aviation* seeks to be an information-providing leader in aeromodeling, reflecting the association's position as the world's largest model aviation organization.

Editorial Offices

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Model Aviation Author Agreement and Assignment

I, _____, am submitting herewith an article and/or other material entitled _____, (the "Work") to *Model Aviation*, a magazine owned exclusively by the Academy of Model Aeronautics, Inc., a nonprofit organization at 5161 E. Memorial Dr., Muncie IN 47302, for consideration of publication in *Model Aviation*.

1) I hereby assign and sell to *Model Aviation* all right, title, and interest to the Work, including (a) its title and theme; and (b) all copyright, including renewals and extensions, in the Work, and any adaptation or version of it in the United States or anywhere throughout the world.

2) *Model Aviation* agrees to pay me a fee based on the number of magazine pages expected to be reserved for the Work and any additional amount to cover additional work and expenses required to get the article into a publishable condition, and the sufficiency of such fee is hereby acknowledged by me.

3) I enclose with this signed and dated Agreement and Assignment a copy of the Work.

4) I respect and warrant that: (a) I am the sole author or one of the coauthors (if applicable each coauthor must provide a signed copy of this Agreement and Assignment) of the Work and have made no commitments with anyone else with respect to the Work or its use; (b) the Work is an original and does not infringe upon statutory or common law copyright, proprietary right, or any other right of any other person; (c) the statements in the Work are true (unless the Work is described as a fiction); and (d) the Work has not been previously published, unless otherwise agreed in writing.

5) I shall indemnify and hold *Model Aviation* harmless from any and all loss, damage, and/or author expense (including reasonable attorney's fees) that *Model Aviation* may suffer or incur by reason of any claim, arising from the breach or alleged breach of any of the representations or warranties that I have made.

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7) I agree to take such actions and execute such documents, at *Model Aviation's* expense, as may reasonably be required by *Model Aviation* to secure and/or protect the rights obtained by *Model Aviation* according to this Agreement.

I acknowledge reading, accepting, and agreeing to the terms of this Agreement and Assignment by my signature.

Name

AMA #

Signature

Address

Date

Request for Taxpayer Identification Number and Certification

Give Form to the
requester. Do not
send to the IRS.

► Go to www.irs.gov/FormW9 for instructions and the latest information.

Print or type.
See Specific Instructions on page 3.

1 Name (as shown on your income tax return). Name is required on this line; do not leave this line blank.	
2 Business name/disregarded entity name, if different from above	
3 Check appropriate box for federal tax classification of the person whose name is entered on line 1. Check only one of the following seven boxes. ☐ Individual/sole proprietor or single-member LLC ☐ Limited liability company. Enter the tax classification (C=C corporation, S=S corporation, P=Partnership) ► _____ Note: Check the appropriate box in the line above for the tax classification of the single-member owner. Do not check LLC if the LLC is classified as a single-member LLC that is disregarded from the owner unless the owner of the LLC is another LLC that is not disregarded from the owner for U.S. federal tax purposes. Otherwise, a single-member LLC that is disregarded from the owner should check the appropriate box for the tax classification of its owner. ☐ Other (see instructions) ► _____	4 Exemptions (codes apply only to certain entities, not individuals; see instructions on page 3): Exempt payee code (if any) _____ Exemption from FATCA reporting code (if any) _____ (Applies to accounts maintained outside the U.S.)
5 Address (number, street, and apt. or suite no.) See instructions.	Requester's name and address (optional)
6 City, state, and ZIP code	
7 List account number(s) here (optional)	

Part I Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)

Enter your TIN in the appropriate box. The TIN provided must match the name given on line 1 to avoid backup withholding. For individuals, this is generally your social security number (SSN). However, for a resident alien, sole proprietor, or disregarded entity, see the instructions for Part I, later. For other entities, it is your employer identification number (EIN). If you do not have a number, see *How to get a TIN*, later.

Note: If the account is in more than one name, see the instructions for line 1. Also see *What Name and Number To Give the Requester* for guidelines on whose number to enter.

Social security number									
				-					
or									
Employer identification number									
				-					

Part II Certification

Under penalties of perjury, I certify that:

1. The number shown on this form is my correct taxpayer identification number (or I am waiting for a number to be issued to me); and
2. I am not subject to backup withholding because: (a) I am exempt from backup withholding, or (b) I have not been notified by the Internal Revenue Service (IRS) that I am subject to backup withholding as a result of a failure to report all interest or dividends, or (c) the IRS has notified me that I am no longer subject to backup withholding; and
3. I am a U.S. citizen or other U.S. person (defined below); and
4. The FATCA code(s) entered on this form (if any) indicating that I am exempt from FATCA reporting is correct.

Certification instructions. You must cross out item 2 above if you have been notified by the IRS that you are currently subject to backup withholding because you have failed to report all interest and dividends on your tax return. For real estate transactions, item 2 does not apply. For mortgage interest paid, acquisition or abandonment of secured property, cancellation of debt, contributions to an individual retirement arrangement (IRA), and generally, payments other than interest and dividends, you are not required to sign the certification, but you must provide your correct TIN. See the instructions for Part II, later.

**Sign
Here**

Signature of
U.S. person ►

Date ►

General Instructions

Section references are to the Internal Revenue Code unless otherwise noted.

Future developments. For the latest information about developments related to Form W-9 and its instructions, such as legislation enacted after they were published, go to www.irs.gov/FormW9.

Purpose of Form

An individual or entity (Form W-9 requester) who is required to file an information return with the IRS must obtain your correct taxpayer identification number (TIN) which may be your social security number (SSN), individual taxpayer identification number (ITIN), adoption taxpayer identification number (ATIN), or employer identification number (EIN), to report on an information return the amount paid to you, or other amount reportable on an information return. Examples of information returns include, but are not limited to, the following.

- Form 1099-INT (interest earned or paid)

- Form 1099-DIV (dividends, including those from stocks or mutual funds)
- Form 1099-MISC (various types of income, prizes, awards, or gross proceeds)
- Form 1099-B (stock or mutual fund sales and certain other transactions by brokers)
- Form 1099-S (proceeds from real estate transactions)
- Form 1099-K (merchant card and third party network transactions)
- Form 1098 (home mortgage interest), 1098-E (student loan interest), 1098-T (tuition)
- Form 1099-C (canceled debt)
- Form 1099-A (acquisition or abandonment of secured property)

Use Form W-9 only if you are a U.S. person (including a resident alien), to provide your correct TIN.

If you do not return Form W-9 to the requester with a TIN, you might be subject to backup withholding. See What is backup withholding, later.